

**SYNTHETIC TRAINING RECORD — FICTIONAL PARTIES, PEOPLE,
AGENCIES, SYSTEMS, IDENTIFIERS, AND EVENTS — NOT A REAL
FILING OR CYBERSECURITY GUIDE**

Public Redacted Vaughn Index

Filed: August 4, 2025 **Synthetic docket:** SYN-DMD-25-CV-0914 **Request:** DOE-FOIA-2024-OG-041 **Access:** Public counterpart

This index describes the twelve responsive records and the grounds asserted for withheld material. It is organized from document-by-document review, but several harm explanations apply to recurring functional categories. The descriptions avoid any value or arrangement that ORER claims is protected.

The playbook records were compiled and used to prevent, recognize, and coordinate a response to unlawful attacks within the wholly fictional Grid Sentinel program. Their assigned law-enforcement purpose arises from that use, not simply from their storage by a government component. Governance records document approval and supersession but do not organize a response.

Public notices mark the kind of field omitted: [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE], or [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL]. These notices reveal no underlying value. A sealed exercise counterpart addresses the same semantic segment on each corresponding page and substitutes harmless invented labels.

Current and Superseded Operational Decision Trees

GS-DT-4.2 — Operational Decision Tree, version 4.2 — February 12, 2024 — 18 pages.

Withheld in full. ORER asserts 7(E) across all pages because the document's arrangement connects [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION] to [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER]. Selected portions also receive 7(F) treatment where duty and safety fields occur. The stated 7(E) harm is reconstruction of the nonpublic decision organization; the stated 7(F) harm is interference with a protective human function.

GS-DT-3.7 — Operational Decision Tree, version 3.7 — September 19, 2022 — 16 pages.

Withheld in full. The agency relies on 7(E) for the superseded sequence and branch relationships. It reasons that comparison with a later edition could reveal what fictional condition changed. Some segments also carry 7(F) where [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE] or [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE] appears.

For both records, ORER says headings and fragments cannot be released because their placement would expose the protected order or leave isolated words without independent meaning. The requester disputes that categorical segregation conclusion.

Decision-Tree 7(E) Categories

The “decision condition” category covers an invented predicate used by the approved tree after an exercise indicator is already available. It does not identify a method for detecting an event. The public index displays [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION] in place of the predicate. ORER classifies the nonpublic application as a technique or procedure.

The “response order” category identifies the relative placement of abstract review choices. Its public marker is [REDACTED—FICTIONAL RESPONSE ORDER]. The agency asserts that disclosing order, even without a real threshold, would reveal implementation detail. A general awareness that responders use triage does not, in ORER’s view, make this edition’s arrangement public.

The “escalation value” category is treated as a guideline when it indicates when the framework changes classification. [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] replaces the assigned value. ORER predicts that disclosure could permit a hypothetical actor to anticipate the change and thereby risk circumvention of law.

Where a segment combines condition and order, both descriptions apply but the page is counted once. The agency’s harm statement is functional rather than a separate narrative for each occurrence.

Exercise and Quality-Review Decision Records

GS-DT-T1 — Tabletop Decision Tree, exercise edition — November 6, 2023 — 14 pages.

Released in part. The title, exercise status, revision history, general purpose, and several administrative directions are visible. ORER removes fictional condition and ordering fields under 7(E). It also removes a limited number of role or contact fields under 7(F). The production contains pages without redaction as well as pages carrying one or both exemptions.

GS-DT-QA — Quality Review Decision Map — March 4, 2024 — 12 pages. Released in part. This record tests whether approved branches are documented consistently; it does not test a real network. ORER withholds [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DECISION CONDITION] and relationships that would permit comparison with GS-DT-4.2. Neutral review headings and approval language remain public.

For these partial records, the agency states that each blackout was checked for context. A field was retained where adjacent visible words were thought to expose the protected relationship. ORER's initial review concluded that other administrative matter could be understood independently and produced it. The office invokes no exemption for the fact that the editions exist or for their stated dates.

Escalation Matrices and the 7(F) Category

GS-EM-4.2 — Cyber-Incident Escalation Matrix, version 4.2 — February 12, 2024 — 20 pages. Withheld in full. ORER asserts 7(E) for the association between [REDACTED—FICTIONAL ESCALATION VALUE] and an ordered classification. It also asserts 7(F) for duty-role, contact-channel, and safety-reference fields interspersed throughout the matrix.

GS-EM-3.7 — Prior Escalation Matrix, version 3.7 — September 19, 2022 — 18 pages. Released in part. General legends and administrative history are visible. Protected cells use [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE], [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL], and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL SAFETY REFERENCE] where the agency applies 7(F); selected classification relationships also carry 7(E).

For 7(F), ORER groups fields by their protective function. It predicts that exposing a role, channel, safety reference, or escalation position could facilitate interference with people involved in a response. The agency does not identify a threatened individual or provide a distinct public causal account for every cell. It maintains that contextual review supports the common category; Open Grid contests that level of specificity.

Remaining Matrix and Current Coordination Appendix

GS-EM-T1 — Exercise Escalation Matrix — November 6, 2023 — 16 pages. Released in part. Exercise labels, document-control text, and general classification headings are public. ORER invokes 7(E) for fictional ordering and guideline values, and 7(F) for identified human-function fields. Because the edition is an approved exercise record, the agency says its organized relationships remain nonpublic even though it is not used on a live system.

GS-CA-4.2 — Response-Coordination Appendix, version 4.2 — February 12, 2024 — 24 pages. Released in part. This appendix contains administrative ownership statements, general coordination prose, and invented role assignments. Public text remains around notices such as [REDACTED—FICTIONAL DUTY ROLE] and [REDACTED—FICTIONAL CONTACT CHANNEL]. ORER also removes sequence relationships under 7(E) where the appendix associates a decision state with an ordered coordination act.

The office says disclosure could reveal how the fictional framework allocates a protective function or could expose an implementation relationship. It uses the same functional harm language applied to comparable matrix fields. A reader of this public index cannot derive an actual contact, route, timing, system characteristic, or response method from the descriptions.

Prior Coordination Appendices and Segregability

GS-CA-3.7 — Prior Response-Coordination Appendix — September 19, 2022 — 22 pages. Released in part. ORER withholds selected ordering, role, channel, and safety fields. It retains the prior edition's title, revision trail, and general recordkeeping language. Comparison-sensitive relationships receive 7(E); human-function fields receive 7(F), with overlap noted at affected segments.

GS-CA-T1 — Exercise Response-Coordination Appendix — November 6, 2023 — 18 pages. Released in part. Public portions identify the exercise status and neutral administrative responsibilities. The agency removes protected fictional assignments and coordination relationships using the category-specific notices.

Reviewers state that they examined each source page and released meaningful nonexempt context. They treated a title, date, approval marker, general purpose statement, or administrative heading as potentially separable. They retained surrounding language when its position was thought to identify a removed relationship. For the fully withheld records, they concluded that no useful fragment could be detached from the operational organization.

The index supplies this segregation explanation at the record and category level. It does not list a separate line-by-line reason for every remaining blackout, which is part of the dispute presented in the case.

Governance Records and Disposition Summary

GS-GV-04 — Revision Approval Memorandum — February 12, 2024 — 12 pages.

Released in full. It identifies the suite version, approval status, effective date, document owners, and administrative review history. ORER found no operational condition, protected sequence, or safety-related field requiring deletion.

GS-GV-03 — Supersession and Distribution Log — September 19, 2022 — 10 pages.

Released in full. It records which fictional edition superseded another and documents controlled distribution in general terms. The log contains no live recipient list or contact value.

The twelve-record total is 200 pages. Three records comprising fifty-four pages are withheld in full. Seven records comprising 124 pages are released in part. Two records comprising twenty-two pages are released in full. Production RLS-OG-001 contains 146 images; sixty-eight have no blackout and seventy-eight have at least one.

On the seventy-eight redacted images, sixty-two cite 7(E), fifty-one cite 7(F), and thirty-five cite both. All fully withheld pages cite 7(E), while thirty-nine also cite 7(F). These page flags can overlap and do not measure the volume of removed text.

Public Certification

Elian Voss certifies that this index uses the identifiers and lengths of the authoritative responsive records. Each description was derived from the processing worksheet and custodian review. The index omits content the agency claims is protected and uses visible category notices so the existence of a redaction is apparent.

The corresponding sealed exercise index contains nine logical pages addressing the same record groups in the same order. Its substituted labels are invented and inert. The counterparts are designed to support controlled review without placing a raw sealed location or hidden value into a public reference.

ORER states that disclosure of the remaining 7(E) material would expose nonpublic organization or, for guidelines, risk anticipation and circumvention. It states that disclosure of remaining 7(F) fields could facilitate interference with a protective human function. It further states that reviewers found no additional meaningful segregable portion during the initial review.

The agency recognizes that these assertions are subject to de novo judicial evaluation. This public index neither resolves that question nor provides any real cybersecurity instruction. Executed August 4, 2025.

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